MAINSTAR

When there's *just not enough* hours in a day to run tape audits… Mainstar® has the solution.

HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls™

A Mainstar: *Fast*Audit/390™ selectable unit
to solve your tape corruption issues fast!

THE PROBLEM

- Tapes in 'failed create' or 'failed recycle' status require the IBM Enhanced AUDITMEDIACONTROLS command to correct them.
- IBM AUDITMEDIACONTROLS can run for hours, days, or even weeks.
- Not correcting tape errors can lead to data loss and the allocation of more tapes to DFSMShsm (HSM).

The fact is, tape corruption issues occur in all HSM environments. During normal HSM processing, control data set records are kept in memory for up to 45 minutes before being written out to tape or the control data set being updated. When HSM is abnormally terminated, these records can be lost and the tape is left in failed create status. Tapes in failed create status can never be recycled or reused. In addition, several conditions can cause tape control data set records to become corrupted.

The current resolution is to run the DFSMShsm Enhanced AUDIT command 'AUDITMEDIACONTROLS VOLUMES(volser) FIX'. Executing this command can require hours or days to complete depending on the tape media, number of data sets, and the tape subsystem performance. Executing the Enhanced AUDITMEDIACONTROLS command also has a negative impact on the performance of HSM during its entire execution, consuming additional CPU and I/O operations to the control data sets.

THE SOLUTION

HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls is the solution to your tape corruption issues! **HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls**, Mainstar: *Fast*Audit/390's newest selectable unit, introduces new technologies that allow audit functions to process outside of the HSM environment. As a result, there is *no* impact to HSM automatic and on-demand processing, such as a migration, backup, recall, recycle, etc.. More importantly, the tape errors are corrected or the TTOC can be completely rebuilt in a fraction of the time of the Enhanced AUDIT commands. What this means is:

- Tape errors can be corrected as often as needed.
- HSM does not need to consume additional tape resources because tapes have been invalidated due to corruption.
- Access to important data assets on HSM tape is always maintained.
- You are always in control of the audit, diagnostic, and corrective action, by using a simple ISPF interface.
- Multiple tape audits can be executed concurrently.

HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls provides multiple audit procedures to diagnose and resolve tape errors:

FAUDITFD extracts and audits all known information about the tape. Output from this process is used as input to the FAUDITFL audit procedures.

FAUDITFL is executed after FAUDITFD. Additional diagnostics are performed after reading the physical tape. You can then decide the corrective action(s) to take depending on the errors detected.

Choose from three processing options:

FAST: This option executes in just a few seconds and reports TTOC and other corruption on the tape.

THOROUGH: This option intelligently bypasses valid records, searches out the records in error, and automatically creates corrective actions. If the TTOC can not be read, or is missing, and you are processing in a FAST or THOROUGH mode, HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls will automatically switch to the INTENSE mode and a WTO is issued telling the operator automatically.

INTENSE: This option can rebuild the complete tape TTOC for every data set *66 times faster* than the Enhanced AUDIT MEDIACONTROLS command or correct every bad block count found. The INTENSE option can be used to return tapes to HSM control that have been inadvertently scratched, as long as the tapes have not been written over.

FAUDITFT completely rebuilds the TTOC for tapes that the TTOC has been corrupted or is missing. This procedure executes the INTENSE option.

Imagine the power and peace of mind you'll have when you have a tool that can correct HSM tape errors, quickly and easily *before* data is lost, without impacting your HSM environment. You are always in control of the corrective actions to be taken, and a new INI file provides you with the additional ability to automate which corrective action to take for each type of error.

DON'T WAIT UNTIL IT'S TOO LATE!

Find out how **HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls** can solve your tape corruption issues. Contact Mainstar Software Corporation at product_info@mainstar.com.

Mainstar Software Corporation has been serving the storage and recovery needs of major organizations for over 20 years.

Careful attention to our customers' needs, progressive technology, and in-depth technical knowledge are all key elements in our success.

Mainstar offers software, consulting, and training solutions. Please call for more information.

Web address:

www.mainstar.com

Email address:

info@mainstar.com

Mainstar Software Corporation
P.O. Box 4132
Bellevue, WA 98009
U.S.A

Tel: 1-425-455-3589
or
1-800-233-6838 ext. 300
Fax: 1-425-455-1992

Mainstar Software Corporation Ltd.
The Gables
Market Square
Princes Risborough
Bucks HP270AN
England

Tel: +44-(0)1844-347173
Fax: +44-(0)1844-346627

Mainstar International Ltd.
P.O. Box 1624
Macquarie Centre
North Ryde, NSW 2113
Australia

Tel: +61-(0)2-9888-1777
Fax: +61-(0)2-9888-1588

©2003 Mainstar is a registered trademark and *Fast*Audit/390 and HSM *Fast*Audit-MediaControls are trademarks of Mainstar Software Corporation. IBM, DFSMShsm, and ABARS are trademarks of the International Business Machines Corporation.

006-0128-05 (07/10/03)